Behavioural Psychology

Individual Reflective Assignments — Course: 21GNH401TA

Course:	21GNH401TA Behavioral Psychology
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Assignment 1: Understanding Yourself for Effectiveness

Based on Unit 1 – Understanding Self for Effectiveness

Q1. Positive vs. Negative Self-Concept

Based on Self-Concept

Positive: I am a good listener. I am hardworking. I am loyal to my friends. I am creative when I put effort in. I am capable of learning new things quickly. I am kind to people around me. I handle pressure reasonably well. I am honest. I am a supportive sibling. I am curious about how things work.

Negative: I am not good enough when compared to others. I always procrastinate on important tasks. I am too hard on myself when I fail.

Reflection: Honestly, the positive statements took more effort to write than the negative ones. My daily self-talk tends to lean negative — I often catch myself thinking I am not doing enough or that others are ahead of me. The positive list felt more like something I had to convince myself of rather than something I believe naturally.

Q2. Self-Concept Circle

Based on Self-Concept

Body: I am average in height and reasonably healthy, though I don't exercise as consistently as I should. I often feel self-conscious about my appearance in social situations. Personality: I am introverted but warm once I get comfortable with someone. I tend to overthink, which can slow me down. Abilities: I am good at analysing problems logically. I struggle with public speaking but I am improving. Role in family: I am the older sibling and feel responsible for setting a good example. I feel proud when I support my parents. Hardest section: The 'Body' section was hardest because I rarely think about how I see my physical self — writing honestly about it felt uncomfortable.

Q3. Twenty Statements Test — Who Am I?

Based on Self-Concept

1. I am a student. (Social)
2. I am an older brother. (Social)
3. I am someone who thinks too much. (Psychological)
4. I am a night-owl. (Physical)
5. I am a chess player. (Social)
6. I am anxious about the future. (Psychological)
7. I am a person who loves music. (Social)
8. I am tall. (Physical)

9. I am someone who values honesty. (Psychological)
10. I am a friend who shows up when it matters. (Social)

Reflection: Social statements form the largest part of my list (5 of 10), followed by Psychological (3), Physical (2). This suggests that I currently understand myself mainly through my relationships and social roles, while the other parts also contribute to my identity.

Q4. The Wheel of Emotions

Based on Understanding Emotions

During the week before my end-semester exams last semester, I experienced a blended emotional state that was difficult to name at the time. The core emotions were: anxiety (fear of failing), excitement (hoping to prove myself), frustration (feeling unprepared), hope (believing I could still turn it around), and loneliness (feeling isolated while everyone else seemed calm and ready). What triggered this combination was seeing the syllabus and realising I had underestimated how much was left to study. The mix of fear and hope was especially conflicting — I wanted to do well but wasn't sure I had put in the work to deserve it.

Q5. The Feeling Wheel – Naming My Emotions

Based on Understanding Emotions

During a group presentation in class, I felt deeply embarrassed. It was not just 'nervous' — it was the specific feeling of being exposed when I stumbled on a question the professor asked me directly and I could not answer it properly.

What triggered it: I had not prepared that particular section thoroughly, and the question caught me off guard in front of everyone.

How I responded: Initially I went silent for a moment, then gave a vague answer and let my teammate take over. After class, I felt a lingering sense of shame. I ended up making a note to never enter a group presentation without fully understanding every part, even sections I didn't personally prepare.

Q6. Reframing a Challenge Optimistically

Based on Optimism

Challenge: I scored poorly on a mid-semester test in a subject I genuinely thought I had studied well for.

Initial feeling: 'I am just not smart enough for this. I clearly don't have what it takes. Everyone else seems to understand it effortlessly — maybe I'm in the wrong course.'

Optimistic reframe: 'This one result doesn't define my intelligence. It tells me that my current study method isn't working for this subject, and that's something I can change. Other students may have struggled privately too. This is temporary and specific to how I prepared — not to who I am.'

What changed: The first version made me feel helpless and global — like something was permanently wrong with me. The reframed version made the problem feel specific and solvable, which actually motivated me to change my approach.

Q7. My Optimism Test Result

Based on Optimism

I took the Optimism Test on PsychologyToday.com. My result showed a moderate level of optimism — meaning I lean positive in stable situations, but under pressure I tend to slip into pessimistic thinking. This matches how I see myself: I can encourage others easily but struggle to apply the same optimism to my own setbacks. When I fail, I often assume the worst will follow. This result tells me I need to consciously practice applying the same kind of hopeful thinking I offer others to my own challenges —

especially in academics.

Q8. Why Self-Awareness Matters to Me

Based on Self-Awareness

Self-awareness matters to me because without it, I repeat the same mistakes without understanding why. It is the difference between reacting and responding. Real example: During a conflict with a close friend last year, I kept insisting I was right and felt increasingly frustrated that they 'didn't understand.' It was only after the argument cooled down that I realised I had been speaking loudly and dismissively — which shut down any chance of them feeling heard. I had been so focused on being right that I had no awareness of how I was coming across. Had I been more self-aware in the moment, I would have caught that tone shift and the conversation could have ended differently.

Q9. My Johari Window

Based on Self-Awareness

Open (known to me and others): I am a quiet person who takes time to warm up in social settings. My friends and I both know I am not the first to speak in a group. Hidden (known to me, not to others): I often feel deeply uncertain about my career path, even though I project confidence in class. I don't share this because I don't want people to see me as lost. Blind Spot (noticed by others, not fully by me): A close friend once told me that I tend to give unsolicited advice when someone vents to me, even when they just want to be heard. I hadn't realised this until it was pointed out — I genuinely thought I was being helpful.

Q10. My Self-Esteem Tree

Based on Self-Esteem

Roots: My values of honesty and hard work, my family's support, and my belief that effort matters.

Trunk: Resilience, analytical thinking, loyalty, and empathy.

Branches: Student, elder sibling, friend, team member in group projects.

Leaves: Completing my first year of college, helping my sibling with studies, being selected for a college-level quiz competition.

Fruits: A career in engineering that lets me solve real problems, and becoming someone my family is proud of.

Reflection: I am proudest of my roots — specifically my family's trust in me. They gave up a lot to give me this education, and that pushes me harder than any personal ambition ever could. It is the part of my tree that holds everything else up.

Assignment 2: Thinking, Problem-Solving & Life Skills

Based on Unit 2 (Problem Solving & Creativity) and Unit 3 (Life Skills)

Q1. Opening My Mind

Based on Thinking

If humans could only communicate through images, my daily life would change dramatically. In class, taking notes would shift to drawing diagrams and sketches. Friendships would rely on shared photos and gestures, making abstract conversations — about feelings, plans, or ideas — much harder. With family, emotional conversations would become more symbolic and slower. What this showed me: I realised how much of my thinking is language-based. I structure my thoughts in sentences before I even speak or write. Without words, I'd struggle to organise complex ideas. It made me appreciate that language isn't just communication — it's how I think.

Q2. Thinking About My Thinking

Based on Thinking

Last five things I thought about today:

1. Whether I submitted the assignment on the right portal — Future, myself.
2. A funny moment from last week's lab session — Past, someone else.
3. What I'll eat after college today — Future, myself.
4. Worry about whether a friend seemed upset with me — Present/Future, someone else.
5. Whether I'm studying the right things for the upcoming test — Future, myself.

Pattern: Most of my thoughts are future-oriented and self-focused, often loaded with low-level worry. Very little of my thinking is about the present moment. This tells me I spend a lot of mental energy anticipating problems rather than dealing with what's in front of me.

Q3. Fast vs. Slow Thinking in My Life

Based on Thinking

Fast thinking decisions:

1. Chose to skip breakfast to reach college on time — led to poor focus in the first class.
2. Agreed to join a group project without asking about the workload — ended up doing most of the work.
3. Sent an angry text to a friend during a misunderstanding — it escalated the situation.

Slow thinking decisions:

1. Chose my elective subject after researching career relevance — made a good fit.
2. Planned my exam schedule by priority — helped me cover more material effectively.
3. Talked through a conflict with my friend over two days before concluding — resolved it calmly.

Slow thinking consistently led to better outcomes. Fast decisions felt right in the moment but often created problems I had to fix later. The difference was time — slow thinking gave me perspective.

Q4. Reverse Thinking – Flip It Around

Based on Reverse Thinking

To ruin my time management:

1. Check my phone every 10 minutes → Positive: Keep phone on silent during study hours.
2. Never write down tasks, rely on memory → Positive: Maintain a daily to-do list.
3. Start assignments the night before → Positive: Begin at least 3 days before the deadline.

4. Say yes to every distraction → Positive: Assess each request before agreeing.
5. Study without breaks → Positive: Use the Pomodoro method — 25 minutes on, 5 minutes off.
6. Avoid prioritising, treat all tasks equally → Positive: Rank tasks by urgency and importance. This exercise was surprisingly useful. By thinking of the worst habits first, the positive alternatives became very obvious and felt more actionable than a generic list of 'good habits.' Identify an unhelpful habit Flip it into a positive action Practise the action regularly Review and adjust progress Fig. 2.1: Reverse-thinking process

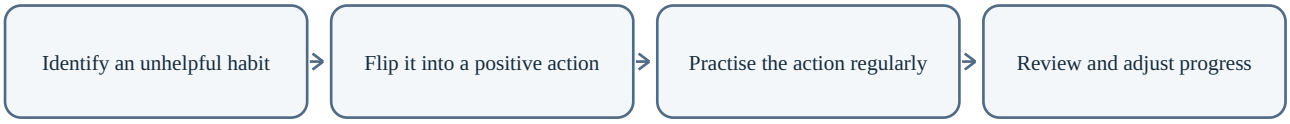


Fig. 2.1: Reverse-thinking process

Q5. My Personal SWOT

Based on Problem Solving Techniques (SWOT)

Area: Time Management

Strengths: I can focus deeply once I start. I am good at breaking tasks into smaller steps. I rarely miss hard deadlines (exams, submissions).

Weaknesses: I procrastinate when a task feels overwhelming. I underestimate how long things take. I tend to spend too long perfecting one thing instead of completing several.

Opportunities: My college offers time management workshops. Using a planner app could help me track progress daily. Setting study groups creates accountability.

Threats: Social media notifications break my concentration. Irregular sleep disrupts my planned routines. Peer activities during exam season reduce study time.

Q6. Active Listening in Practice

Based on Communication

I asked my younger sibling to tell me about their day without me interrupting. They talked about a disagreement they had with a classmate, feeling misunderstood during a group activity, and then cheering up after eating their favourite snack. They seemed relieved talking about it. Summary: They felt dismissed during a group task, tried to explain their side, and eventually let it go after a small comfort break.

Reflection: What was hard was not jumping in with advice. At least twice I had a 'solution' in my head and had to consciously stop myself. I also noticed that when I stayed quiet longer than usual, they shared more. That was an important realisation — sometimes silence invites honesty.

Q7. The Floor Is Yours

Based on Communication (On-the-Spot Activities)

Prompt chosen: (a) A motivating speech to a friend who just failed an exam. 'Hey — I know this feels awful right now, and I'm not going to tell you it doesn't matter, because I know you worked for it. But failing one paper doesn't mean you're failing at life. It means you got information — specific, honest information about what needs to change. Every person you admire has a story with failure in it. The difference is they didn't stop. You still have time, you still have your ability, and you still have people who believe in you. Take today to feel it. Tomorrow, let's make a plan. I'm not going anywhere.'

Q8. Stepping Into Empathy

Based on Empathy

Last month, a close friend told me he was thinking of dropping out because his family was facing financial difficulty and he felt guilty continuing while his parents struggled. As he spoke, I felt a tightness in my chest — not sympathy, but something that felt like his fear sitting inside me too. I could almost feel the weight of choosing between your dream and your family. What I noticed: He wasn't asking for advice — he just needed someone to hear it without judgment. How it made me feel: Grateful for my situation, and also helpless in the most human way — wanting to fix something I couldn't fix. Did it change how I acted? Yes. Instead of offering solutions, I simply said, 'That sounds incredibly heavy to carry alone.' He cried. And somehow that seemed to help more than advice.

Q9. Treating Others Respectfully

Based on Respect

1. My father: I show respect by listening to his advice without immediately becoming defensive and by taking his experiences seriously, even when my opinion is different.
2. My mother: I show respect by hearing her out, helping when needed, and speaking politely. I know that I sometimes become short-tempered when I am tired, and I want to work on that.
3. My teacher: I show respect by arriving on time, paying attention during lectures, completing assigned work, and asking questions in a courteous manner.

Honest evaluation: I try to show respect to all three, but I need to be more consistent in my tone at home and more disciplined about following academic instructions.

Q10. Building It Back Up – Resilience

Based on Resilience

In second semester, our team spent three weeks building a project for a college-level competition. The night before the presentation, one team member accidentally deleted the final presentation file and there was no backup. It felt like a card structure collapsing.

How I responded: Initially I went quiet and felt a rush of panic and anger. But within about twenty minutes, I decided there was no point in being upset — we needed to rebuild immediately. I called the team together at 10 PM and we started from memory. We worked through the night. What helped: Focusing on what was still possible instead of what was lost. The fact that we had lived through the work meant we remembered more than we expected. We presented the next day and placed second. That taught me more about resilience than any lecture ever could.

Assignment 3: Stress, Personality & Socialization

Based on Unit 4 (Stress & Coping) and Unit 5 (Personality, Socialization & Human Values)

Q1. Sorting My Stress

Based on Stress Identification

Controllable (My Choices & Actions) Uncontrollable (Outside My Control)

1. Spending too long perfecting one assignment while delaying other subjects until they feel overwhelming.

1. Teammates in group projects submitting their sections late or with minimal effort right before deadlines.

2. Staying up past 1:30 AM playing online chess or listening to music, which ruins my morning focus.

2. Heavy city traffic and bus delays during my commute that make morning arrival times unpredictable.

3. Agreeing to help friends or classmates with their work even when my own schedule is already packed.

3. Uncertainty about future campus placement market trends and company hiring criteria.

Reflection: Looking at both columns, I notice that I often spend mental energy worrying about the right column (like placement trends or how others behave), which drains the energy I need to fix the left column.

Q2. Recognising My Own Stress Symptoms

Based on Causes & Symptoms of Stress

Physical: When I am stressed before a presentation or test, my stomach feels knotted and heavy, I lose my appetite for breakfast, and my hands get noticeably cold.

Emotional: I experience a quiet, persistent sense of dread and self-doubt — a feeling that I am letting my family down or falling behind everyone else in my batch.

Cognitive: I get stuck in 'what-if' loops. Instead of solving the problem in front of me, my brain jumps five steps ahead to imagine what will happen if I fail the course or ruin my GPA.

Behavioural: I become overly meticulous about small, low-priority tasks — like formatting notes or reorganising files — as a way of procrastinating on the harder task that is actually scaring me, and I become snappy at home when my mother asks how preparation is going.

Q3. The 5-4-3-2-1 Grounding Exercise

Based on Grounding Exercise

I did this exercise sitting in my room this evening when my head felt cluttered with pending tasks: 5 things I can see: My wooden chessboard set up on the side table, the green LED light on my Wi- Fi router, a stack of engineering textbooks, a framed family photo near the monitor, and rain streaks on my window glass. 4 things I can touch: The soft foam cushion of my chair, the cold metal frame of my spectacles, the smooth ceramic surface of my coffee mug, and the woven fabric of my backpack strap. 3 things I can hear: The gentle tapping of light rain against the window grille, the low hum of the refrigerator from the kitchen, and my younger sibling's television playing softly in the next room. 2 things I can smell: The warm aroma of filter coffee in my mug and the damp, earthy smell of wet soil coming through the window. 1 thing I can taste: The lingering sweetness of coffee on my tongue.

Reflection: As someone whose thoughts are almost always in the future, this exercise was

surprisingly grounding. Naming physical sensations forced my attention into the present moment, and my breathing slowed down noticeably by the time I reached the last step.

Q4. Nature Journaling

Based on Nature Journaling

I spent ten minutes standing on our terrace just before sunset, watching the gulmohar tree by the lane and the sky above it. I noticed how the clouds shifted from pale orange to a deep bruised purple within minutes. Flocks of parakeets flew across in noisy, crooked lines heading toward the larger trees to roost. I could feel a cool evening breeze on my face and hear the rustle of dry leaves scraping across the terrace floor alongside distant temple bells.

Reflection: Normally, even when I step outside, I have earphones in. Standing there without music or a screen made me realise how rarely I let my mind be quiet. My stress level dropped from a tense 7 to a calm 4 simply because nothing up there was asking me to perform or hurry.

Q5. My Go-To Coping Strategy

Based on Strategies of Stress Management

My primary coping strategy when stressed is listening to music with my headphones on while lying in the dark, or playing rapid ten-minute games of chess online. Music is genuinely restorative for me when I use it intentionally for twenty minutes to calm my nervous system after a long college day.

Honest evaluation: However, playing blitz chess when I am stressed is definitely a temporary escape rather than real coping. It gives my brain a fake sense of control and problem-solving while allowing me to avoid the actual academic task I am anxious about. True coping for me happens when I pair a short music break with writing down a small, manageable three-step plan. Notice stress signals Pause and identify the cause Choose a healthy coping action Reflect, recover and reset Fig. 3.1: Healthy coping sequence

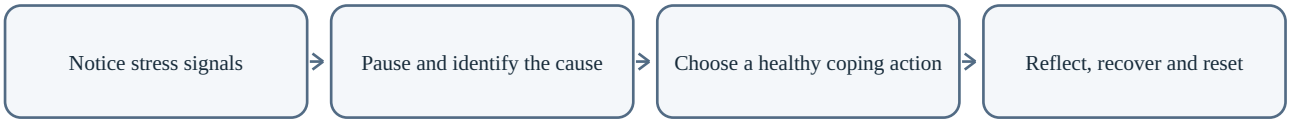


Fig. 3.1: Healthy coping sequence

Q6. My Big Five Personality Profile

Based on The Big Five Personality Test

I completed the test at bigfive-test.com and received these results: Openness: High (86/120), Conscientiousness: High (88/120), Extraversion: Low (49/120), Agreeableness: High (92/120), and Neuroticism: Moderate-High (81/120).

Reflection: The results match how I see myself almost completely. My high Agreeableness and Conscientiousness explain why I care so deeply about being a dependable friend, an example to my sibling, and someone who never misses hard deadlines. At the same time, the combination of high Agreeableness and high Neuroticism explains why I overthink social interactions — like worrying whether a friend is upset with me — and why I take on too much work in group projects rather than risking conflict.

Q7. My Personality Type in Action

Based on Types of Personality (ABCD / MBTI)

Trait chosen: High Agreeableness (from the Big Five). High Agreeableness means valuing

harmony, empathy, and cooperation, which is both a strength and a trap for me. A clear real-life example happened during a group assignment last month. When we divided the four sections of the report, two members immediately claimed the easiest introductory parts and left the complex data analysis and formatting unassigned. Even though I knew it was unfair, my desire to avoid tension in the group made me say, 'It's fine, I'll handle the analysis and put the slides together.' It kept the peace and the project turned out well, but I ended up working until 2 AM alone. Seeing this trait in action showed me that kindness needs boundaries so it doesn't turn into silent resentment.

Q8. Learning the Unwritten Rules

Based on Socialization Simulation

When I was selected for the college quiz club in my first year, I walked into a room of seniors who had known each other for years. The unwritten rules became clear over the first three meetings: never interrupt the quizmaster to argue a point until the round ends; don't brag when you crack a tough 'connect' question; and always credit your partner even if you arrived at the answer ninety percent on your own. How I adapted: Because I am naturally quiet in new groups, I spent the first two weeks observing how the respected seniors carried themselves. I adapted by learning the club's shorthand formats and dry humour, while staying true to myself by remaining humble and supportive toward other first-year members who looked just as nervous as I had felt on day one.

Q9. A Different Perspective

Based on Embracing Diversity

During a semester project, I worked closely with a classmate from Nagaland. One afternoon while waiting for our lab slot, we talked about our hometowns and upbringing. He told me about the Hornbill Festival, how community work is organised through youth morungs in his ancestral village, and how English and Nagamese bridge dozens of distinct tribal languages that can't even be understood across neighbouring hills. What I learned: He also spoke honestly about how exhausting it feels when people in big cities treat students from the Northeast like outsiders in their own country. That conversation stayed with me — it taught me how much richness exists in traditions our school textbooks barely mention, and made me much more conscious of making sure everyone in a group feels genuinely included.